



which require a sensitive approach, you can use soft, blended strokes. At other times you may choose to work slowly, leaving each application of paint to dry before adding the next. Each layer shimmers through subsequent applications, creating gauzy veils of color. When you paint “wet on dry” in this way, the results are controllable, allowing for precise and highly detailed work. Alternatively, you can think in color and compose with the paint, drawing with broad, loose, personal strokes. When you work quickly and boldly, using strokes economically, the medium responds with a pleasing clarity. While many effects

can be planned, sometimes watercolors react unpredictably and the results are unexpected. This spontaneity may at first seem daunting, but you can turn it to your advantage. If you exploit the effects of the accidental spread of the watercolor, rather than creating every mark yourself, the medium will reward you with fresh and original paintings. There are many ways to work in watercolor and the right method is the one that suits you, which may change according to your mood, experience, and subject matter. Experimenting is the key to creating successful watercolor paintings in your own unique style.

